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Set of panels with a mechanical locking device

Abstract

A set including a first panel, a second panel and a mechanical locking device for locking the first panel to the second panel, wherein the first panel includes a first edge surface, the second panel includes a second panel surface, the first edge surface is facing the second panel surface in a locked position of the first and the second panel, the mechanical locking device includes at least one rod-shaped element at the first edge surface, at least one insertion groove at the second panel surface, the rod-shaped element is configured to be inserted into the insertion groove, the rod-shaped element extends at a first angle from the first edge surface, the insertion groove extends into the second panel surface at a second angle from the second panel surface, the mechanical locking device further including at least one locking groove.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/553,325, filed on Aug. 28, 2019, which claims the benefit of Swedish Application No. 1851028-9, filed on Aug. 30, 2018. The entire contents of each of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/553,325 and Swedish Application No. 1851028-9 are hereby incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Embodiments of the present invention relate to panels that may be arranged perpendicular to each other and locked together with a mechanical locking device. The panels may be assembled and locked together to obtain a furniture product, such as a bookshelf, a cupboard, a wardrobe, a box, a drawer or a furniture component.

TECHNICAL BACKGROUND

(2) A furniture product provided with a mechanical locking device is known in the art, as evidenced by WO2015/038059. The furniture product comprises a first panel connected perpendicular to a second panel by a mechanical locking device comprising a flexible tongue in an insertion groove.

(3) The above description of various known aspects is the applicant's characterization of such, and is not an admission that any of the above description is considered as prior art.

(4) Embodiments of the present invention address a need to provide panels that may be easily assembled.

SUMMARY

(5) It is an object of certain aspects of the present invention to provide an improvement over the above described techniques and known art; particularly to facilitate assembling of panels configured to be assembled without the need of using any tools.

(6) A further object of at least certain aspects of the present invention is to facilitate assembling of panels configured to be assembled with a locking device that is easy to manufacture and to use, which reduces the risk of incorrect installation thereof.

(7) A further object of at least certain aspects of the present invention is to facilitate assembling of panels configured to be assembled in a more stable and aesthetic way.

(8) At least some of these and other objects and advantages that will be apparent from the description have been achieved by a set comprising a first panel, a second panel and a mechanical locking device for locking the first panel to the second panel, wherein the first panel comprises a first edge surface and a first panel surface, the second panel comprises a second panel surface, the first edge surface is facing and/or is parallel with the second panel surface in a locked position of the first and the second panel, the mechanical locking device comprises at least one rod-shaped element at the first edge surface and at least one insertion groove at the second panel surface, the rod-shaped element is configured to be inserted into the insertion groove, the rod-shaped element

extends at a first angle from the first edge surface, the insertion groove extends into the second panel surface at an angle from the second panel surface, the mechanical locking device further comprises at least one locking groove at the first edge surface or at the second panel surface and at least one locking part, wherein the locking groove comprises at least one locking surface extending at a third angle from the first edge surface or from the second panel surface, the locking part is configured to be inserted into the locking groove and lock against the locking surface, and the third angle is different than the first angle.

(9) According to an aspect the mechanical locking device is configured to obtain the locked position by displacing first panel relative the second panel in an assembly direction which is essentially parallel with the first panel surface.

(10) According to an aspect the third angle is about 45° to about 90° larger than the first angle.

(11) According to an aspect the locking part is positioned at the first edge surface or at the second panel surface and the locking groove is positioned at the opposite second panel surface or first edge surface.

(12) According to an aspect the first angle is within the range of about 30° to about 60, or within the range of about 40° to about 50, or about 45°.

(13) According to an aspect the assembly direction is essentially parallel with at least one of the first angle and the second angle.

(14) According to an aspect the locking part is flexible.

(15) According to an aspect the locking part, in an unflexed/non-compressed state, is configured to be positioned partly in the locking groove.

(16) According to an aspect the locking part comprises a spring.

(17) According to an aspect the locking part is arranged in a locking part groove on the first edge surface or on the second panel surface.

(18) According to an aspect the locking part, in a flexed/compressed state, is configured to be substantially positioned in the locking part groove.

(19) According to an aspect the insertion groove and/or the locking groove is a drill hole.

(20) According to an aspect the drill hole is a bottom-ended drill hole.

(21) According to an aspect the rod-shaped element is arranged in a rod element groove in the first edge surface.

(22) According to an aspect the set comprises a first panel groove on the first panel surface on the first panel and a second panel groove on the second panel surface of the second panel.

(23) According to an aspect a width of the first panel groove is essentially the same as a width of the second panel groove.

(24) According to an aspect the set further comprises a back panel configured to be inserted in, and optionally to cooperate with, the first and second panel groove.

(25) According to an aspect the first panel comprises a second edge surface, the second panel comprises a third edge surface, the first panel groove is substantially parallel to the second edge surface and the second panel groove is substantially parallel to the third edge surface.

(26) According to an aspect the first panel groove extends substantially along the entire second edge surface and the second panel groove extends essentially along the entire third edge surface.

(27) According to an aspect the first panel groove and/or the second panel groove is bottom-ended.

(28) According to an aspect an extension of the back panel from the first edge of the first panel, when one first panel, one second panel, and one back panel have been assembled, is less than an extension of the rod shaped element from the first edge surface.

(29) According to an aspect the core of the first panel and/or of the second panel may be a wood-based core, such as MDF, HDF, OSB, WPC, plywood or particleboard. The core may also be a plastic core comprising thermosetting plastic or thermoplastic, e.g., vinyl, PVC, PU or PET. The plastic core may comprise fillers.

(30) The first panel and/or the second panel may also be of solid wood.

(31) The first panel and/or the second panel may be provided with a decorative layer, such as a foil or a veneer, on one or more surfaces.

(32) At least some of the above identified and other objects and advantages that may be apparent from the description have been achieved by a locking device for a furniture product in accordance with the above.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) These and other aspects, features and advantages of which embodiments of the invention are capable of, will be apparent and elucidated from the following description of embodiments and aspects of the present invention, reference being made to the accompanying drawings, in which

(2) FIG. 1 shows a 3D view from above of a set in an unassembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(3) FIG. 2 shows a 3D view from above of a set in an unassembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(4) FIG. 3 shows a 3D view from above of a set in an unassembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(5) FIG. 4 shows a 3D side view of a set in an assembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(6) FIG. 5A shows a side view of a set in an unassembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(7) FIG. 5B shows a side view of an embodiment of the rod-shaped element

(8) FIG. 6 shows a side view of a set in an assembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(9) FIG. 7 shows a side view of a set in an unassembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(10) FIG. 8 shows an enlargement of part of the view shown in FIG. 7.

(11) FIG. 9 shows a side view of a set in an assembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(12) FIG. 10 shows an enlargement of part of the set shown in FIG. 9.

(13) FIG. 11 shows a view of a set comprising two of the first panel, two of the second panel and one back panel in an unassembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(14) FIG. 12 shows a side view of a set in an assembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(15) FIG. 13 shows an enlargement of part of the set shown in FIG. 12.

(16) FIG. 14 shows an enlargement of part of the set shown in FIG. 12.

(17) FIG. 15 shows a side view of an embodiment of first panel.

(18) FIG. 16 shows a view of a set comprising two of the first panel, two of the second in an unassembled state of an aspect of the invention.

(19) FIGS. 17A-17D show enlargements of parts of a set during assembling.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(20) Specific embodiments of the invention will now be described with reference to the accompanying drawings. This invention may, however, be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein; rather, these embodiments are provided so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the scope of the invention to those skilled in the art. The terminology used in the detailed description of the embodiments illustrated in the accompanying drawings is not intended to be limiting of the invention. In the drawings, like numbers refer to like elements.

(21) The terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular aspects of the disclosure only, and is not intended to limit the disclosure. As used herein, the singular forms “a”, “an” and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise.

(22) In the drawings and specification, there have been disclosed exemplary aspects of the disclosure. However, many variations and modifications may be made to these aspects without

substantially departing from the principles of the present disclosure. Thus, the disclosure should be regarded as illustrative rather than restrictive, and not as being limited to the particular aspects discussed above. Accordingly, although specific terms are employed, they are used in a generic and descriptive sense only and not for purposes of limitation, for example, definition of dimensions such as width or breadth or height or length or diameter depends on how exemplary aspects are depicted, hence, if depicted differently, a shown width or diameter in one depiction is a length or thickness in another depiction.

(23) It should be noted that the word “comprising” does not necessarily exclude the presence of other elements or steps than those listed and the words “a” or “an” preceding an element do not exclude the presence of a plurality of such elements. It should further be noted that any reference signs do not limit the scope of the claims, that the example aspects may be implemented at least in part by means of both hardware and software, and that several “means”, “units” or “devices” may be represented by the same item of hardware.

(24) The different aspects, alternatives and embodiments of the invention disclosed herein may be combined with one or more of the other aspects, alternatives and embodiments described herein. Two or more aspects may be combined.

(25) Embodiments of the invention are shown in FIGS. **1-16** including a set comprising a first panel **10**, a second panel **20** and a mechanical locking device for locking of the first panel **10** to the second panel **20**. The first panel **10** comprises a first edge surface **11** and a first panel surface **13**. The second panel **20** comprises a second panel surface **22**. The first edge surface **11** is facing or parallel to the second panel surface **22** in a locked position of the first and the second panel **10**, **20**. The mechanical locking device comprises at least one element **31** at the first edge surface **11** and at least one insertion groove **32** at the second panel surface **22**. The element **31** may be rod-shaped. The rod-shaped element **31** is configured to be inserted into the insertion groove **32**. The rod-shaped element **31** extends at a first angle α_1 from the first edge surface **11** and the insertion groove **32** extends into the second panel surface **22** at a second angle α_2 from the second panel surface **22**. When there are more than one element **31**, each element **31** may be arranged parallel to each other element **31**. When there are more than one insertion grooves **32**, each insertion groove **32** may be arranged parallel to each other insertion groove **32**. The mechanical locking device further comprises at least one locking groove **35** at the first edge surface **11** or at the second panel surface **22** and at least one locking part **34**. The locking groove **35** comprises at least one locking surface **37** extending at a third angle β from the first edge surface **11** or from the second panel surface **22**. The locking part **34** is configured to be inserted into the locking groove **35** and lock against the locking surface **37**, and the third angle β is different than the first angle α_1 .

(26) The first panel **10** and the second panel **20** may be panels for a furniture product and may be a part of a frame of a furniture product.

(27) The set may be configured for locking the first panel **10** to the second panel **20** with the first panel surface **13** perpendicular or essentially perpendicular to the second panel surface **22**.

(28) The second panel **20** may comprise a fourth edge surface **25** and the insertion groove **32** may be positioned adjacent the fourth edge surface **25**. The set may be configured for locking the first panel **10** to the second panel **20** with the first panel surface **13** parallel or essentially parallel to the fourth edge surface **25**.

(29) FIGS. **1-3**, **5A**, **7-8**, **11**, and **16** disclose a set according to an aspect in an unassembled state. FIGS. **4**, **6**, **9-10**, and **12-14** disclose a set according to an aspect in an assembled state. The set may be assembled by a displacement of the first panel **10** relative the second panel **20** in an assembly direction **111**, **112**, **114** which is essentially parallel with the first panel surface **13**. The mechanical locking device may be configured to automatically lock the first panel **10** to the second panel **20** when the rod-shaped element **31** is inserted into the insertion groove **32** and the locking part **34** is inserted into the locking groove **35** and locks against the locking surface **37**. The set may be locked when the first edge surface **11** is arranged against the second panel surface **22**.

- (30) The third angle β may be about 45° to about 90° larger than the first angle $\alpha 1$ and/or the second angle $\alpha 2$.
- (31) The locking part **34** may be positioned at the first edge surface **11** or at the second panel surface **22** and the locking groove **35** may be positioned at the opposite second panel surface **22** or the first edge surface **11**.
- (32) The first angle $\alpha 1$ and/or the second angle $\alpha 2$ may be within the range of about 30° to 60° , or within the range of about 40° to 50° , or about 45° . The first angle $\alpha 1$ and the second angle $\alpha 2$ may be parallel or essentially parallel.
- (33) The assembly direction **111**, **112**, **114** may be essentially parallel with the first angle $\alpha 1$ and/or the second angle $\alpha 2$.
- (34) The third angle β of the locking surface **37** may be within the range of about 70° to 110° , or within the range of about 80° to 100° , or within the range of about 85° to 95° , or about 90° .
- (35) The locking part **34** may be flexible.
- (36) The locking part **34**, in an unflexed/non-compressed state, may be configured to be positioned partly in the locking groove **35**.
- (37) The locking part **34** may comprise a spring.
- (38) The locking part **34** may be arranged in a locking part groove **38** on the first edge surface **11** or on the second panel surface **22**.
- (39) The locking part **34**, in a flexed/compressed state, may be configured to be substantially positioned in the locking part groove **38**.
- (40) When the first **10** and second **20** panels are assembled together the locking part **34** may be compressed and is substantially positioned in the locking part groove **38**. The locking part **34** may comprise a spring that facilitates the compression of the locking part **34**. When the first panel **10** is displaced in relation to the second panel **20** in the assembly direction, the rod-shaped element **31** becomes inserted into the insertion groove **32**. When the locking part **34** meets the locking groove **35** the locking part **34** may expand out from the locking part groove **38** and protrude into the locking groove **35**. The first panel **10** and second panel **20** will then be locked together, since the positioning of a part of the locking part **34** in the locking groove **35** hinders the first panel **10** from being displaced in relation to the second panel **20** in a direction opposite to the assembly direction.
- (41) The insertion groove **32** and/or the locking groove **35** may be a drill hole. The drill hole may be a bottom-ended drill hole.
- (42) The insertion groove **32** may have a diameter **D2**.
- (43) The insertion groove **32** may comprise a chamfer **60** or a rounding, which is configured to guide the rod shaped element during assembling, as shown in FIG. **8**.
- (44) The rod-shaped element **31** may be arranged in a rod element groove **36** on the first edge surface **11** on the first panel **10** or on the second panel surface **22** on the second panel **20**.
- (45) The rod-shaped element **31** may have a diameter **D1**. The diameter **D2** of the insertion groove **32** may be larger than the diameter **D1** of the rod-shaped element **31**. The diameter **D2** of the insertion groove **32** may be about 0.3 to about 0.8 mm larger than the diameter **D1** of the rod-shaped element **31** for optimal assembly.
- (46) According to an aspect the set may comprise a first panel groove **12** on the first panel surface **13** on the first panel **10** and/or a second panel groove **23** on the second panel surface **22** of the second panel **20**.
- (47) The first panel groove **12** on the first panel surface **13** may comprise a width **W1**.
- (48) The second panel groove **23** on the second panel surface **22** may comprise a width **W2**.
- (49) The width **W1** of the first panel groove **12** may be essentially the same as the width **W2** of the second panel groove **23**.
- (50) The set may further comprise a back panel **40**. The back panel **40** may be configured to be inserted in, and optionally cooperate with, the first panel groove **12** and the second panel groove **23**.

(51) FIG. 6 shows that the back panel 40 may be assembled to the first 10 and second 20 panel by displacing the back panel 40 relative the first 10 and second 20 panel in an assembly direction 113 which is essentially perpendicular to the second panel surface 22 of the second panel 20. A thickness T of the back panel 40 may be essentially the same as the width W1, W2 of the first 12 and/or second 23 panel groove.

(52) There may be a play between the back panel 40 and the first 12 and/or second 23 panel groove which may facilitate a displacement of an edge of the back panel 40 in the first 12 and/or second 23 panel grooves. The play may be in the range of about 0 mm to about 0.5 mm, or about 0.1 mm to about 0.2 mm.

(53) In one aspect the width W1, W2 of the first 12 and/or second 23 panel groove minus a thickness T of the back panel 40, i.e., ΔW , is equal to or larger than an extension H of the back panel 40 in relation to the first panel 10 or second panel 20 after a first panel 10, a second panel 20 and a back panel 40 have been assembled, i.e., $\Delta W \geq H$, see FIGS. 12-15.

(54) FIG. 13 shows an embodiment comprising a positioning element 50, for positioning the back panel 40 relative the first 12 and/or second 23 panel groove. The positioning element 50 may comprise a first wedge element 51 and second wedge element 52.

(55) In one aspect H is less than an extension D of the rod shaped element 31 from the first edge surface 11.

(56) The rod shaped element 31 may have an extension E along the first edge surface 11.

(57) In one aspect, if a set comprising two of the first panel 10 and two of the second panel 20 are to be assembled, at least one panel 10, 20 may have a width W1, W2 of the first 12 and/or second 23 panel groove that allows for a displacement of the extension H of the back panel 40 within the first 12 and/or second 23 panel groove. The displacement may be equal to or larger than ΔW . In one aspect, all panels 10, 20 have the same width W1, W2 of the first 12 and second 23 panel groove to facilitate the production of the panels.

(58) A length of the back panel 40 may be designed to avoid the extension H of the back panel 40.

(59) An edge of the back panel 40 may be essentially flush with the first edge 11 surface of the first panel 10.

(60) FIG. 15 shows a side view of an embodiment of first panel 10 with the first 12 panel groove. The first 12 panel groove may comprise a width W1 and a height H1. The first panel 10 may comprise a second edge surface 14 and the second panel 20 may comprise a third edge surface 24. The first panel groove 12 may be substantially parallel to the second edge surface 14 and the second panel groove 23 may be substantially parallel to the third edge surface 24.

(61) The first panel groove 12 may extend substantially along the entire second edge surface 14 and the second panel groove 23 may extend essentially along the entire third edge surface 24.

(62) The first panel groove 12 and/or the second panel groove 23 may be bottom-ended.

(63) The first 12 and/or second 23 panel groove may be formed by mechanical cutting, such as milling or sawing.

(64) The first panel groove 12 may be formed in the first panel surface 13 and in a core of the first panel 10. The second panel groove 23 may be formed in the second panel surface 22 and in a core of the second panel 20.

(65) The first edge surface 11 may comprise two or more of said rod-shaped element 31 and the second panel surface 22 may comprise two or more of said insertion groove 32, and vice versa, which may be arranged linearly, wherein each of the rod-shaped elements 31 is configured to be inserted into one insertion groove 32.

(66) A locking of the first panel 10 to the second panel 20 in a direction which is parallel with the second panel surface 22 may be obtained by the locking part 34 being inserted into the locking groove 35 and locking against the locking surface 37. The locking surface extends at the third angle β from the first edge surface 11, where third angle β is about 45° to about 90° larger than the first angle α 1.

(67) A cross cut of the insertion groove **32**, in a plane parallel to the second panel surface **22**, may have a shape that matches a cross cut of the rod-shaped element **31**, in a plane parallel to the first edge surface **11**. An advantage of this may be that an improved locking of the first panel **10** to the second panel **20** is obtained and that the assembly of the set of panels is done easily.

(68) The rod-shaped element **31** and the insertion groove **32** are disclosed more in detail in FIGS. **5A-8** and **10**, which show cross cuts along the rod-shaped element **31** and the insertion groove **32**.

(69) FIG. **5A** shows an embodiment of the locking part **34** comprising a guiding surface **87** at outer edge of the locking part **34**. The guiding surface is configured to cooperate with an outer edge the locking groove **35** during the insertion of locking part **34** into the locking groove **35**.

(70) FIG. **5B** shows an embodiment of the rod-shaped element **31** which may be of an elongated shape and comprise a length direction **86**, a width direction **85** and a centre line **81** extending in the length direction. According to an aspect the rod-shaped element **31** is configured to be inserted in the rod element groove **36** on the first edge surface **11**.

(71) According to an aspect the rod-shaped element **31** is configured to be inserted in the rod element groove **36** on the second panel surface **22**.

(72) According to an aspect the rod-shaped element **31** may be configured to be attached in the rod element groove **36** by friction.

(73) According to an aspect the rod-shaped element **31** may be configured to be glued in the rod element groove **36**.

(74) According to an aspect the rod-shaped element **31**, the rod element groove **36** and the insertion groove **32** may have a substantially circular shape, although other shapes, such as triangular, rectangular, square, etc. are possible.

(75) According to one aspect the locking groove **35** and the locking part **34** may have a substantially circular shape, although other shapes, such as triangular, rectangular, square, etc. are possible.

(76) According to an aspect, which is shown in FIG. **7**, a first edge surface **11** may have at least one element **31**, while the opposite edge surface may have at least one insertion groove **32**.

(77) According to a further aspect, a first edge surface **11** may have a combination of at least one element **31** and at least one insertion groove **32**. A corresponding second panel surface **22** may have a corresponding combination of at least one insertion groove **32** and at least one element **31**.

(78) According to an aspect, which is shown in FIG. **8**, the position of at least one rod shaped element **31** may be positioned at first distance **83** from the second edge surface **14**. The first distance may be measured from the second edge surface **14** to a centre line **81** of the rod shaped element **31**. The corresponding insertion groove **32** may be positioned at a second distance **84** from the third edge surface **24**. The second distance may be measured from the third edge surface **24** to a centre line **82** of the insertion groove **32**. The first distance may be different from the second distance which may increase the locking force.

(79) The difference between the first distance and the second distance may be in the range of about 0.1 mm to about 0.5 mm.

(80) According to an aspect the rod-shaped element **31** is made from one or more of a wood based material, a polymer material, which may comprise reinforcement, such as glass fibre or a metal.

(81) According to an aspect the rod shaped element **31** may have a waxed surface to facilitate assembly.

(82) According to an aspect the rod-shaped element **31** may be configured to cooperate, in a locked position, with the bottom surface of the insertion groove **32**.

(83) The sidewalls of the insertion groove **32** and the locking groove **35** may comprise material of the core of the first panel **10** or the second panel **20**, dependent on in which panel they are made. According to an aspect they may also be enforced with, e.g., metal or glass fibre.

(84) According to an aspect the locking groove **35** may be impregnated/reinforced with a liquid.

(85) According to an aspect the first panel **10** and the second panel **20** may be assembled by a

displacement of the first panel **10** relative the second panel **20** in an assembly direction which is essentially parallel with the first panel surface **13** as shown in FIGS. **5A**, **11** and **16**. The mechanical locking device is according to an aspect configured to automatically lock the first panel **10** to the second panel **20** when the rod-shaped element **31** is inserted into the insertion groove **32** and the locking part **34** is inserted into the locking groove **35** and locks against the locking surface **37** by said displacement of the first panel **10** relative the second panel **20**. The set may be locked when the first edge surface **11** is arranged against the second panel surface **22**.

(86) According to an aspect the first panel **10** may comprise two or more of said first edge surface **11** according to the above. Put in another way, one or more of said rod-shaped elements **31** may be positioned at two or more of the edges of the first panel **10**, as disclosed in FIGS. **2-4**, **9**, **11**, **12** and **16**.

(87) According to an aspect the second panel **20** may comprise two or more of said fourth edge surface **25** according to the above. Put in another way, one or more of said insertion grooves **32** may be positioned adjacent two or more of the edges of the second panel **10**, as disclosed in FIGS. **1-4**, **9**, **11**, **12** and **16**.

(88) According to an aspect, as shown in FIG. **11**, two of the first panels **10**, two of the second panels **20**, and one back panel **40** may be assembled.

(89) A left embodiment of the of the first panel **10** may be assembled to a bottom embodiment of the second panel **20** by displacing the left embodiment of the first panel **10** relative the bottom embodiment of the second panel **20** in the assembly direction **111**. A right embodiment of the of the first panel **10** may be assembled to the bottom embodiment of the second panel **20** by displacing the right embodiment of the first panel **10** relative the bottom embodiment of the second panel **20** in the assembly direction **112**. An embodiment of the back panel **40** may be assembled to the left and right embodiment of the first panel **10** and the bottom embodiment of the second panel **20** by displacing the embodiment of the back panel **40** in an assembly direction **113** which is essentially perpendicular to the second panel surface **22** of the bottom embodiment of the second panel **20**. A top embodiment of the second panel **20** may be assembled to the left and right embodiment of the first panel **10** and the embodiment of the back panel **40** by displacing the top embodiment of the second panel **20** in the assembly direction **114**.

(90) According to an aspect, as shown in FIG. **16**, two of the first panel **10**, two of the second panel **20**, may be assembled.

(91) A left embodiment of the of the first panel **10** may be assembled to a bottom embodiment of the second panel **20** by displacing the left embodiment of the first panel **10** relative the bottom embodiment of the second panel **20** in the assembly direction **111**. A right embodiment of the of the first panel **10** may be assembled to the bottom embodiment of the second panel **20** by displacing the right embodiment of the first panel **10** relative the bottom embodiment of the second panel **20** in the assembly direction **112**. A top embodiment of the second panel **20** may be assembled to the left and right embodiment of the first panel **10** and the embodiment of the back panel **40** by displacing the top embodiment of the second panel **20** in the assembly direction **114**.

(92) A length **93** of the back panel **40** which in the locked position may be inserted in the panel groove **12** of the first panel **10** may be essentially the same or greater than a length **94** of the first panel **10** at the second edge surface **14** of the first panel. The length **93** of the back panel **40** may be equal to the length **94** of the first panel **10** plus about half the height **H1** of the panel groove **12** to about two times the height **H1** of the panel groove **12** or equal to the length **94** of the first panel **10** plus the height **H1** of the panel groove **12**. FIG. **11** shows the length **93** of the back panel **40** which extend between an upper edge **87** of the back panel and a lower edge **88** of the back panel.

(93) FIGS. **17A-D** show enlargements of parts of a set during assembling. FIG. **17A** shows an embodiment in a first position in which the back panel **40** is inserted in the panel groove **12** of the first panel **10**. The upper edge **87** of the back panel **40** is below the first edge surface **11** of the first panel. FIG. **17C** shows that in this first position the lower edge **88** of the back panel may contact a

lower surface **89** of the panel groove **23** of the lower second panel **20**.

(94) FIG. **17B** shows the embodiment in a second position in which, an upper second panel **20** has been displaced **114** and assembled to the first panel **10**, and the back panel **40** has been displaced to a position in which the upper edge **87** of the back panel **40** is within the panel groove **23** of the upper second panel **20**. FIG. **17D** shows that in this second position the lower edge **88** of the back panel may be at a distance **91** from the lower surface **89** of the panel groove **23** of the lower second panel **20**. The lower edge **88** of the back panel **40** may be positioned at a distance **91** from the second panel surface **22** of the second panel. The distance may be within the range of about $\frac{1}{3}$ to about $\frac{2}{3}$ a height **H2** of the panel groove **23** of the second panel, or about half the height **H2** of the panel groove **23** of the second panel.

(95) The height **H2** of the panel groove **23** of the lower second panel groove may be greater than the height **H2** of the panel groove **23** of the upper second panel groove. The set may be rotated such that the gravity causes the displacement of the back panel to obtain the position in which the upper edge **87** of the back panel **40** is within the panel groove **23** of the upper second panel **20**.

(96) The back panel may be displaced by gravity or by hand and the position in which the upper edge **87** of the back panel **40** is within the panel groove **23** of the upper second panel **20** may be maintained by arranging a positioning element **92** between the panel and the panel groove **12** of the first panel and/or between the back panel and the panel groove **23** of the second panel.

(97) Embodiments of the first panel groove **12** may comprise a width **W1** which is essentially the same as a thickness **T** of the back panel **40**. A part of the first panel groove **12** may be wider which may allow an embodiment of the positioning element **50** to be positioned between the back panel and the first panel groove **12** to maintain the position in which the upper edge **87** of the back panel **40** is within the panel groove **23** of the upper second panel **20**.

(98) Embodiments of the second panel groove **24** may comprise a width **W2** which is essentially the same as a thickness **T** of the back panel **40**. A part of the second panel groove **23** may be wider which may allow an embodiment of the positioning element **50** to be positioned between the back panel **40** and the second panel groove **23** to maintain the position in which the upper edge **87** of the back panel **40** is within the panel groove **23** of the upper second panel **20**.

(99) The back panel may be displaceable and the position in which the upper edge **87** of the back panel **40** is within the panel groove **23** of the upper second panel **20** may be maintained by an embodiment of the locking device **4** disclosed in WO2019/125292 or WO2019/125291. The entire contents of WO2019/125292 and WO2019/125291 are hereby incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

(100) The core of the first panel **10** and/or of the second panel **20** may be a wood-based core, such as MDF, HDF, OSB, WPC, plywood or particleboard. The core may also be a plastic core comprising thermosetting plastic or thermoplastic, e.g., vinyl, PVC, PU or PET. The plastic core may comprise fillers.

(101) The first panel **10** and/or the second panel **20** may also be of solid wood.

(102) The first panel **10** and/or the second panel **20** may be provided with a decorative layer, such as a foil or a veneer, on one or more surfaces.

(103) According to an aspect the set of panels are resilient panels. The resilient panels may comprise a core comprising thermoplastic material. The thermoplastic material may be foamed.

(104) The thermoplastic material may comprise polyvinyl chloride (PVC), polyester, polypropylene (PP), polyethylene (PE), polystyrene (PS), polyurethane (PU), polyethylene terephthalate (PET), polyacrylate, methacrylate, polycarbonate, polyvinyl butyral, polybutylene terephthalate, or a combination thereof. The core may be formed of several layers.

(105) The aspects described above may comprise a decorative layer, such as a decorative foil comprising a thermoplastic material. The thermoplastic material of the decorative layer may be or comprise polyvinyl chloride (PVC), polyester, polypropylene (PP), polyethylene (PE), polystyrene (PS), polyurethane (PU), polyethylene terephthalate (PET), polyacrylate, methacrylate,

polycarbonate, polyvinyl butyral, polybutylene terephthalate, or a combination thereof. The decorative foil may be printed, for example by direct printing, rotogravure, or digital printing. According to an aspect the decorative layer comprises melamine, a high pressure laminate (HPL) or a veneer.

(106) The aspects described above may comprise a wear layer such as a film or foil. The wear layer may comprise thermoplastic material. The thermoplastic material may be polyvinyl chloride (PVC), polyester, polypropylene (PP), polyethylene (PE), polystyrene (PS), polyurethane (PU), polyethylene terephthalate (PET), polyacrylate, methacrylate, polycarbonate, polyvinyl butyral, polybutylene terephthalate, or a combination thereof.

(107) The aspects described above may comprise a wood base core, such as HDF, MDF, plywood, particleboard, OSB or Masonite.

(108) The different aspects, embodiments and alternatives described above may be combined with one or more of the other described aspects, embodiments and alternatives.

Embodiments

(109) 1. A set comprising a first panel (10), a second panel (20) and a mechanical locking device for locking the first panel (10) to the second panel (20), wherein the first panel (10) comprises a first edge surface (11) and a first panel surface (13), the second panel (20) comprises a second panel surface (22), the first edge surface (11) is facing or parallel to the second panel surface (22) in a locked position of the first and the second panel (10, 20), the mechanical locking device comprises at least one rod-shaped element (31) at the first edge surface (11) and at least one insertion groove (32) at the second panel surface (22), the rod-shaped element (31) is configured to cooperate with the insertion groove (32) in the locked position, the rod-shaped element (31) extends at a first angle (α_1) from the first edge surface (11), the insertion groove (32) extends into the second panel surface (22) at a second angle (α_2) from the second panel surface (22), the mechanical locking device further comprises a locking groove (35) at the second panel surface (22) and a locking part (34) at the first edge surface (11) or a locking groove (35) at the first edge surface (11) and a locking part (34) at the second panel surface (22), the locking groove (35) comprises at least one locking surface (37) extending at a third angle (β) from the first edge surface (11) or from the second panel surface (22), the locking part (34) is configured to cooperate with the locking groove (35) and lock against the locking surface (37) in the locked position, the third angle (β) is different than the first angle (α_1), the first angle (α_1) is within the range of about 30° to 60°, or within the range of about 40° to about 50, or about 45, and the mechanical locking device is configured to obtain the locked position by displacing first panel (10) relative the second panel (20) in an assembly direction which is essentially parallel with the first panel surface (13).

(110) 2. The set as in embodiment 1, wherein the assembly direction (111, 112, 114) is essentially parallel with at least one of the first angle (α_1) and the second angle (α_2).

(111) 3. The set as claimed in embodiment 1 or 2, wherein the third angle (β) is about 45° to about 90° larger than the first angle (α_1).

(112) 4. The set as in any one of the preceding embodiments, wherein the third angle (β) of the locking surface (37) is in the range of about 70° to 110°, or within the range of about 80° to 100%, or within the range of about 85° to 95°, or about 90°.

(113) 5. The set as in any one of the preceding embodiments, wherein the locking part (34) is flexible.

(114) 6. The set as in any one of the preceding embodiments, wherein the locking part (34), in an unflexed/non-compressed state, is configured to be positioned partly in the locking groove (35).

(115) 7. The set as in any one of the preceding embodiments, wherein the locking part (34) comprises a spring.

(116) 8. The set as in any one of the preceding embodiments, wherein the locking part (34) is arranged in a locking part groove (38) on the first edge surface (11) or at the second panel surface (22).

- (117) 9. The set as in claim 8, wherein the locking part (34), in a flexed/compressed state, is configured to be substantially positioned in the locking part groove (38).
- (118) 10. The set as in any one of the preceding embodiments, wherein at least one of the insertion groove (32) and the locking groove (35) is a drill hole.
- (119) 11. The set as in claim 10, wherein the drill hole is a bottom-ended drill hole.
- (120) 12. The set as in any one of the preceding embodiments, wherein the rod-shaped element (31) is arranged in a rod element groove (36) in the first edge surface (11).
- (121) 13. The set as in any one of the preceding embodiments, wherein set comprises a first panel groove (12) on the first panel surface (13) of the first panel (10), and a second panel groove (23) on the second panel surface (22) of the second panel (20).
- (122) 14. The set as in claim 13, wherein a width (W1) of the first panel groove (12) is essentially the same as the width (W2) of the second panel groove (23).
- (123) 15. The set as in any of embodiments 13 to 14, wherein the set further comprises a back panel (40) configured to be inserted in, and optionally to cooperate with, the first and second panel groove (12, 23).
- (124) 16. The set as in any of embodiments 13 to 15, wherein the first panel (10) comprises a second edge surface (14), the second panel (20) comprises a third edge surface (24), the first panel groove (12) is substantially parallel to the second edge surface (14) and the second panel groove (23) is substantially parallel to the third edge surface (24).
- (125) 17. The set as in any of embodiments 13 to 16, wherein the first panel groove (12) extends substantially along the entire second edge surface (14) and the second panel groove (23) extends essentially along the entire third edge surface (24).
- (126) 18. The set as in any of embodiments 13 to 17, wherein at least one of the first panel groove (12) and the second panel groove (23) is bottom-ended.
- (127) 19. The set as in any of embodiments 16 to 18, wherein an extension (H) of the back panel (40) from the first edge (11) of the first panel (10), when one first panel, one second panel and one back panel have been assembled, is less than an extension of the rod shaped element (31) from the first edge surface (11) of the first panel (10).

Claims

1. A set comprising a first panel, a second panel and a mechanical locking device for locking the first panel to the second panel, wherein: the first panel comprises a first edge surface and a first panel surface, the second panel comprises a second panel surface, the first edge surface is facing or parallel to the second panel surface in a locked position of the first and the second panel, the mechanical locking device comprises at least one rod-shaped element at the first edge surface and adjacent a front edge of the first panel, and at least one insertion groove at the second panel surface, the rod-shaped element is configured to cooperate with the insertion groove in the locked position, the rod-shaped element extends at a first angle from the first edge surface, the insertion groove extends into the second panel surface at a second angle from the second panel surface, the mechanical locking device further comprises a locking groove at the second panel surface and a locking part at the first edge surface and adjacent a back edge of the first panel, the rod-shaped element is positioned between the locking part and the front edge, the locking groove comprises at least one locking surface extending at a third angle from the second panel surface, the locking part is configured to cooperate with the locking groove and lock against the locking surface in the locked position, the third angle is different than the first angle, the first angle is within the range of about 30° to 60°, the locking part is arranged in a locking part groove on the first edge surface, wherein the locking part is configured to resiliently retract into the locking part groove and is biased to extend in a direction away from a bottom surface of the locking part groove, and the first and second panels are configured to become locked by displacing the first panel relative to the

second panel surface in an assembly direction which is essentially parallel with the first angle, during which time the rod-shaped element slides into the insertion groove and the locking part resiliently retracts at least partially into the locking part groove via contact between an end surface of the locking part and the second panel surface, at least until the locking part springs into the locking groove such that, in the locked position of the first and second panels, the locking part extends into the locking groove.

2. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein the locking part comprises a beveled outer edge which is configured to cooperate with an outer edge of the locking groove when the locking part springs into the locking groove.

3. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein the third angle of the locking surface is in the range of about 70° to 110°.

4. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein the locking part is flexible.

5. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein the locking part, in a flexed/compressed state, is configured to be positioned in the locking part groove.

6. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein the locking part comprises a spring.

7. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein the rod-shaped element is arranged in a rod element groove in the first edge surface.

8. The set as claimed in claim 7, wherein rod-shaped element is configured to be glued in the rod element groove.

9. The set as claimed in claim 7, wherein rod-shaped element comprises a wood based material.

10. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein at least one of the insertion groove and the locking groove is a drill hole.

11. The set as claimed in claim 10, wherein the drill hole is a bottom-ended drill hole.

12. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein the set further comprises a first panel groove on the first panel surface of the first panel and between the locking part and the back edge.

13. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein set comprises a first panel groove on the first panel surface of the first panel, and a second panel groove on the second panel surface of the second panel.

14. The set as claimed in claim 13, wherein a width of the first panel groove is essentially the same as the width of the second panel groove.

15. The set as claimed in claim 13, wherein the set further comprises a back panel configured to be inserted in, and optionally to cooperate with, the first and second panel grooves.

16. The set as claimed in claim 15, wherein an extension of the back panel from the first edge of the first panel, when the first panel, the second panel and the back panel have been assembled, is less than an extension of the rod shaped element from the first edge surface of the first panel.

17. The set as claimed in claim 13, wherein the first panel comprises a second edge surface, the second panel comprises a third edge surface, the first panel groove is substantially parallel to the second edge surface and the second panel groove is substantially parallel to the third edge surface.

18. The set as claimed in claim 17, wherein the first panel groove extends substantially along the entire second edge surface and the second panel groove extends essentially along the entire third edge surface.

19. The set as claimed in claim 13, wherein at least one of the first panel groove and the second panel groove is bottom-ended.

20. The set as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first and second panels are configured to become locked by sliding the end surface of the locking part along the first or second panel surface, during which time the rod-shaped element slides into the insertion groove and the locking part resiliently retracts at least partially into the locking part groove, at least until the locking part springs into the locking groove in the direction away from the locking part groove such that, in the locked position of the first and second panels, the locking part extends into the locking groove.
